

PROSPER AWUNI

Security Engineer | SIEM / XDR | Microsoft Sentinel | Detection Engineering | SOAR Automation |
Cloud Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Security Engineer specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) engineering. I have hands-on experience designing, building and maintaining scalable security detection and response capabilities using Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), developing detection rules and SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation and Response) automation playbooks in Kusto Query Language (KQL) and PowerShell, and optimising security telemetry to deliver high-fidelity, low-noise alerting at enterprise scale. I understand detection-as-code principles and have experience working with logging pipelines, data quality improvement and security telemetry coverage analysis. I also bring cloud security engineering experience across Microsoft Azure and a strong MITRE ATT&CK-aligned approach to detection content development. I am UK-based and available to travel to UK sites at short notice, and I am excited by the opportunity to contribute to a technically advanced security engineering function building best-in-class detection and response capabilities.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel -- log source onboarding, custom connector deployment, KQL analytics rules, workbook development, detection-as-code, alert tuning and telemetry coverage mapping
- **XDR and Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), CrowdStrike Falcon -- end-to-end configuration, detection policy management and alert integration
- **Detection Engineering:** MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rule development; mapping detection coverage to adversary tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs); alert logic design and continuous tuning
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps playbooks; enrichment workflows; automated containment and response actions; PowerShell and KQL-based automation
- **Security Telemetry and Logging:** Log pipeline management, data quality review, telemetry gap analysis and cost optimisation across cloud and on-premises sources
- **Cloud Security Engineering:** Azure security architecture, cloud-native SIEM integration, Conditional Access, identity telemetry and cloud workload protection
- **Scripting and Tooling:** PowerShell automation, KQL query development; familiarity with Python for security tooling
- **Incident Response Support:** Active participation in IR investigations, using SIEM and XDR telemetry; NIST 800-61 framework
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 -- Present

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Designing, building and maintaining detection and response capabilities in Microsoft Sentinel, developing KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK and continuously tuning detection logic against real-world threat actor activity observed in the environment.
- Building and optimising SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel using Logic Apps and PowerShell, automating enrichment workflows, alert triage steps and containment actions to reduce mean time to respond (MTTR).

- Managing security telemetry coverage: onboarding new log sources, validating data quality, identifying telemetry gaps and improving log pipeline reliability across cloud and on-premises sources.
- Administering Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000+ user estate, configuring detection policies, tuning XDR alerts and integrating signals into Sentinel.
- Administering CrowdStrike Falcon EDR including Prevent policy management, Insight threat hunting and NG-SIEM rule development, delivering scalable endpoint detection across a diverse device fleet.
- Engineering Azure identity and access security controls using Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA and SSO federation, with monitoring of identity telemetry in Microsoft Sentinel for anomalous authentication activity.
- Running incident response for confirmed security events, applying detection coverage learnings from each incident to improve detection rule logic and reduce future dwell time.
- Conducting vulnerability management using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io and AppCheck, feeding findings back into the detection engineering backlog to ensure detection coverage for newly identified attack paths.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) -- Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 -- March 2025

Cyber Security Analyst

- Delivered SIEM-based threat monitoring and alert triage, investigating security events and building institutional knowledge of common attack patterns to inform detection rule improvements.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across UAL, establishing baseline detection policies and onboarding telemetry into Microsoft Sentinel.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts to reduce manual analyst workload on repetitive triage tasks and accelerate incident response workflows.
- Contributed to log source onboarding projects, working with infrastructure teams to ensure security-relevant event data reached the SIEM reliably and at appropriate fidelity.
- Produced detection coverage documentation and threat-to-detection mapping aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, identifying gaps and prioritising new rule development.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

February 2021 -- March 2022

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Maintained endpoint security, identity and access management and infrastructure security controls within a cloud-first Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment.
- Supported vulnerability scanning and remediation activities, and contributed to security tooling configuration and monitoring.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rule library in Microsoft Sentinel at UAL, increasing detection coverage across credential access, lateral movement and persistence tactics by over 60% within six months.
- Built automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced average phishing incident triage time by approximately 30 minutes per event, freeing analyst capacity for higher-complexity investigations.
- Led the successful onboarding of 15 new log sources into Microsoft Sentinel, including cloud application logs and identity telemetry, closing critical visibility gaps identified in the threat model.
- Identified a telemetry gap in Microsoft Defender for Identity that was preventing detection of a known pass-the-hash attack technique; engineered a compensating detection rule in Sentinel that closed the gap within 48 hours.
- Delivered a Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercise that uncovered five undetected lateral movement paths; used findings to drive five new MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+

- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote/Hybrid (UK)